



The city that sees ahead.

A Strategic Intelligence Operating System for the City of Cape Town — a live, source-linked model of the city that briefs its leadership every morning.

Prepared for the Executive Mayor

Confidential — working draft

THE PROBLEM

You govern in real time. Your information doesn't.

Reports are photographs of the past

By the time a quarterly report reaches this office, the water was lost, the road failed, the budget slipped. You are reading history, not steering.

The truth lives in 30+ silos

Finance in SAP. Water in telemetry. Complaints in service requests. Crime with SAPS. No one — however brilliant — holds it all in one head at once.

The city forgets

Why a budget was cut, who owned a mitigation, what was promised for review. Institutional memory walks out the door with every election and resignation.

Every hard decision this office makes is made against stale, scattered, unattributed information. That is the problem worth paying to remove.

THE PRODUCT — DEFINED

What exactly is Helm?

Helm is a **Strategic Intelligence Operating System**: a continuously updated, source-linked model of the city — its money, water, roads, safety, and services — with reasoning engines on top that turn raw movement into **risks, opportunities, and recommended decisions**, delivered as a daily executive brief.

IT WATCHES

Live departmental feeds, Treasury returns, open data — ingested continuously, not compiled quarterly.

IT VERIFIES

Every number carries a resolvable public source and a verification badge. Defensible in council, in media, in court.

IT REASONS

Forecasting, risk scoring, opportunity detection and simulation engines — explainable arithmetic, not black-box magic.

IT REMEMBERS

A decision register that links every choice to its owner, its risk, and its review date — memory that survives turnover.

One sentence: **Helm is the strategic twin of Cape Town — the city, modelled, watched, and argued over by software that shows its work.**

POSITIONING

What Helm is not

Not another dashboard

Dashboards show numbers and wait for you to notice. Helm **argues**: it ranks what matters, says why, attaches evidence, and proposes the decision. Power BI is a window; Helm is an advisor.

Not a consultancy report

A consultant sells you a photograph for R2–3 million and leaves. Helm is the camera, the analyst, and the archive — producing that report **every morning**, forever fresh.

Not a chatbot on your data

Helm's scores and forecasts are deterministic and explainable — the AI writes the prose, never the arithmetic. Ask "why?" of any number and it opens its evidence.

The report is the output. The machine that makes the report obsolete-proof is the product.

"My team is excellent. Why can't they build this report?"

They can — **once**. That is precisely the point.

Your best analyst, unaided

- Compiles the brief in days; it is stale on arrival
- Watches the metrics they were asked to watch
- Their reasoning lives in their head — and leaves with them
- Cannot re-verify 200 published figures every week
- One brief consumes them; the city has fifty problems

Your best analyst, running Helm

- The brief is on the desk at 06:00, compiled by no one
- Every metric watched every day; anomalies surface themselves
- Every score traceable: Likelihood × Impact × Trend × Confidence
- Sources re-checked automatically; changes flagged
- The team is freed to act on intelligence, not assemble it

Helm doesn't compete with your team. It is a force multiplier for them —
the difference between owning a telescope and having someone describe the
sky to you weekly.

UNDER THE HOOD — IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

Four layers, one morning brief

1 · INGEST

Connect

SAP finance, water telemetry, service requests, Treasury s71 returns, SAPS releases, open data — pulled on their natural cadence.



2 · VERIFY

Attribute

Each figure is bound to its source with a badge: Verified, Needs verification, or Estimate. Provenance travels with the data.



3 · REASON

Judge

Engines forecast trends, score risks, find redeployable underspend, and simulate "what if" — all explainable, all evidence-linked.



4 · BRIEF

Decide

Wins to celebrate, risks needing decisions, opportunities, and a decision register — in the mayor's language, every morning.

Runs in the City's own cloud tenancy if required. POPIA-aligned. The AI layer is swappable and never invents a number — it only writes the narrative around numbers the engines computed.

THE TRUST PRINCIPLE

Every number can defend itself.

Click any figure in Helm and it opens its own report: the trend, the score arithmetic, and the **public source it came from** — a budget book page, a Treasury return, a DWS bulletin, a SAPS quarter.

Verified

Cross-checked against the cited public source. Quote it in council without flinching.

Needs verification

Sourced but awaiting re-check — Helm says so on the face of the number instead of hiding it.

Estimate

Modelled or derived, with the method attached. Honest uncertainty beats confident fiction.

When a journalist asks "where does that number come from?", the answer is a link — not a scramble.

WHERE WE STAND — NO THEATRE

What is real today, and what the pilot wires live

Working now

- Full reasoning core: forecasting, risk scoring, opportunity detection, simulation
- Executive brief, drill-down reports, provenance badges, decision register
- Curated, source-linked indicators from the 2026/27 budget, DWS, Treasury
- Daily "Pulse" — what moved since the last period, and whether that is good news

Demonstration-grade (pilot upgrades)

- Operational metric series are demonstration data — the pilot replaces them with live departmental feeds
- Crime and staffing claims flagged "Needs verification" until the exact SAPS quarter is attached
- Simulation elasticities are first-order; refined with departmental input in month three

We show you this slide on purpose. **A vendor who hides seams will hide failures.** Helm's product includes its own transparency panel — you will always see which feed is live and which is not.

THE PROPOSAL

A 90-day pilot with one hard success test

Days 1–30 · Wire

- Data access MOU with two sponsor departments (proposed: Water & Sanitation, Finance)
- First live feeds: monthly finance extract + water zone metering / NRW series
- Deploy inside City tenancy or POPIA-compliant hosting

Days 31–60 · Prove

- Daily brief generated from live data — zero human compilation
- Provenance audit: every headline number resolves to its source
- Decision register adopted in one Mayco workflow

Days 61–90 · Decide

- Simulation calibrated with departmental elasticities
- Second domain wired (service requests or roads)
- Go / no-go review against the success test

Success test: on day 90, the Monday morning brief exists — live, sourced, uncompiled by any human — or you do not pay another rand.

INVESTMENT

Priced to be bought, not tendered to death

PHASE	PRICE	WHAT IT BUYS
90-day pilot Fixed price, success-tested	R180,000 once-off	Two live departmental integrations, daily brief, provenance audit, decision register — deliberately under the R200k competitive-bid threshold so it can proceed on written quotations.
Helm for Cape Town Core subscription	R95,000 per month	Daily executive brief, all wired feeds monitored, provenance re-verification, Pulse, decision register, unlimited executive seats. ~R1.14m/year.
Helm Command Full platform	R160,000 per month	Everything in Core plus decision simulation, all 14 domains, ward-level twin, priority integration of new feeds, quarterly strategy reviews with our team.

For calibration: a single strategy review from a major consultancy costs **R1.5–3 million** and is stale on delivery. Helm Core costs less than one junior analyst — and never sleeps, never resigns, never forgets.

TIMING

Why this, why now

The economics just flipped

Reasoning AI that cost thousands per month two years ago now costs less than a tank of petrol. The moat is no longer the model — it is the wiring, the provenance, and the trust. That work starts now or a competitor does it first.

Your data strategy needs a flagship

The City has invested in open data and digital governance. Helm is the visible executive payoff of that investment — the place where the strategy becomes something the mayor touches every morning.

Deliverables before 2027

A 90-day pilot decided this quarter puts live, provable results on the table well inside the current term — a governance-innovation story no other metro in Africa can tell yet.

First metro on Helm sets the reference. Every other metro then buys "what Cape Town has."

STRAIGHT ANSWERS

The risks — and who carries them

"Our data is sensitive."

Helm runs inside the City's own cloud tenancy if required. POPIA compliance is a design constraint, not a patch. The pilot's MOU defines exactly what is accessed, by whom, and for what.

"AI makes things up."

In Helm, AI writes prose — never numbers. Scores and forecasts are deterministic arithmetic you can audit. Kill the AI layer entirely and every figure still stands.

"Integrations always slip."

That is why the pilot is fixed-price with a binary success test. Integration risk is ours. If day 90 arrives without a live, uncompiled brief, the pilot fee is the end of your exposure.

"What if you disappear?"

Data stays in your tenancy; exports are open formats; the seed and provenance registers are yours. No hostage-taking. Continuity terms are in the contract, not in goodwill.

THE ASK

Three signatures start it.

- **Approve the 90-day pilot** — R180,000 fixed, success-tested, no tender required.
- **Name two sponsor departments** — we propose Water & Sanitation and Finance, where the pain and the data are both real.
- **Sign the data-access MOU** — scoped, POPIA-aligned, revocable.

Your team can produce this report — once. Helm produces it every morning, from live systems, with every number able to defend itself. And it never forgets why a decision was made.

Helm · Trusted with foresight

Pilot can start within 14 days of signature